



England Test captain Ben Stokes has been ruled out of the upcoming Champions Trophy and the preceding white-ball tour of India. The all-rounder was not included in the ODI squads after suffering a left hamstring injury during the third Test between England and New Zealand. Jos Buttler will retain the captaincy of the two white-ball teams despite England faltering in the 50-over and T20 World Cups. The India series and Champions Trophy will mark England's first limited-overs tour and tournament under coach Brendon McCullum.

Afghanistan beat Zimbabwe to clinch the three-match ODI series 2-0. The first match was reduced to a 28-over-per-side contest but was eventually called off due to incessant rain. Afghanistan took the lead after registering its biggest win in ODIs — by 232 runs — in the second game. Chasing 287, Zimbabwe was bundled out for 54, its joint fourth-lowest total in the format, with A.M. Ghazanfar **(right)** and Naveed Zadrar picking up three wickets each. The teenage spinner Ghazanfar shone again by taking a fiver in the final game to help Afghanistan win by eight wickets and claim the series 2-0.



GETTY IMAGES